

Oppo Reno 15

A reliable camera phone that avoids extremes

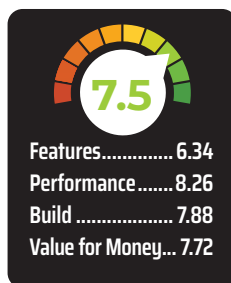
If you are looking for a new phone mainly for the camera, the sub Rs 40,000 bracket feels just right. But the real confusion begins the moment you see a slew of options, with all of them promising flagship-level photography. And yet, whenever this discussion comes up, I usually mention the Oppo Reno series. Over the years, Reno has quietly built a reputation as a phone you can travel with, something that stays dependable when you are constantly on the move, pulling out your phone for quick shots, videos and everyday moments. In my experience with Reno, and without sugarcoating it, this association has been more than just marketing talk.

This year, for a surprise, Oppo has shaken things up. The Reno 15 series is more layered, with the new Oppo Reno 15 Pro Mini sitting right in between the regular Reno 15 and the Reno 15 Pro. Prices have gone up, and so have the expectations. The 15 Pro gives you the ultimate camera phone experience, with the 15 Pro Mini also focusing on that compact design element. The standard Reno 15, on the other hand, takes the role of an all-rounder at its price point.

Of course, not everything is brand new with the Reno 15, and some decisions do carry over from the previous generation Reno 14.

While I have a lot to talk about the Pro models, I spent my time with the Reno 15, the variant most people are likely to buy. Instead of testing it in familiar surroundings, I took it with me to Sri Lanka and used it as my primary phone. No planned shoots,

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no controlled conditions, just long days, changing light, crowded streets, and the kind of travel where your phone has to keep up without complaint. That experience forms this review, and here's what living with the Oppo Reno 15 was really like.

DISPLAY

The Oppo Reno 15 comes with a 6.59-inch AMOLED panel with a 120Hz refresh rate and support for HDR10+ video playback. With Gorilla Glass 7i on top, it feels like a complete package. Oppo claims up to 600 nits in regular use and 1,200 nits in bright conditions, which suggests it should be comfortable to use both indoors and outdoors. Right before I tell you the testing results, I can say this phone has one of the best displays in the segment, and the reason is fine-tuning.

In our display testing using Calman and Spectral C6, we found that the panel covers the entire colour gamut, about 99.6%, which is something rare to see in this segment. More importantly, colours feel accurate and natural. The phone scored an average DeltaE of 1.2; most colour differences are so small that your eyes simply will not notice them. So, in daily use, you will find your photos, videos, Netflix and UI elements look natural.

White balance is handled well too. Whites look clean and neutral, not bluish or overly warm, and greys do not pick up unwanted colour tints.

As expected from an OLED panel, blacks are truly black, which gives the display strong contrast, something you will notice immediately when watching videos or using dark mode.

Brightness is another pleasant surprise. Real-world testing shows the screen can push much higher in direct sunlight, touching around 2,000 nits. In simple terms, the Reno 15 remains readable outdoors, not by blasting brightness, but by using good contrast and efficient panel tuning.

PERFORMANCE

The Oppo Reno 15 5G is powered by Qualcomm's Snapdragon 7 Gen 4 chipset, built on a 4nm manufacturing process. On paper, the company claims a meaningful generation uplift with the CPU offering up to a 27% improvement, the GPU seeing a 30% boost, and the NPU delivering a sizable 65% jump for AI-related workloads.

In everyday use, the Reno 15 largely behaves like a modern upper midrange phone. General tasks like app switching, web browsing, social media, navigation and image editing run smoothly, with no obvious stutters or slowdowns. Gaming performance is equally predictable rather than headline-grabbing. Titles like BGMI run lag-free at up to 90fps on low settings, and thermal management remains under control, but not during extended sessions. In